WaterManagement

Distributed Systems — Practical assignment 2

Adrián Casero Galindo — 48801791T Nicolás Serrano García — 77043897S

30 October 2026

Contents

1. General overview
2. Following an irrigation request
3. Central and the field operator
4. Inside a watering station
5. The socket protocols: NAP and HCP
6. The Kafka messages
7. State, concurrency and recovery
8. Deployment
9. Testing and results
10. Source references

1. General overview

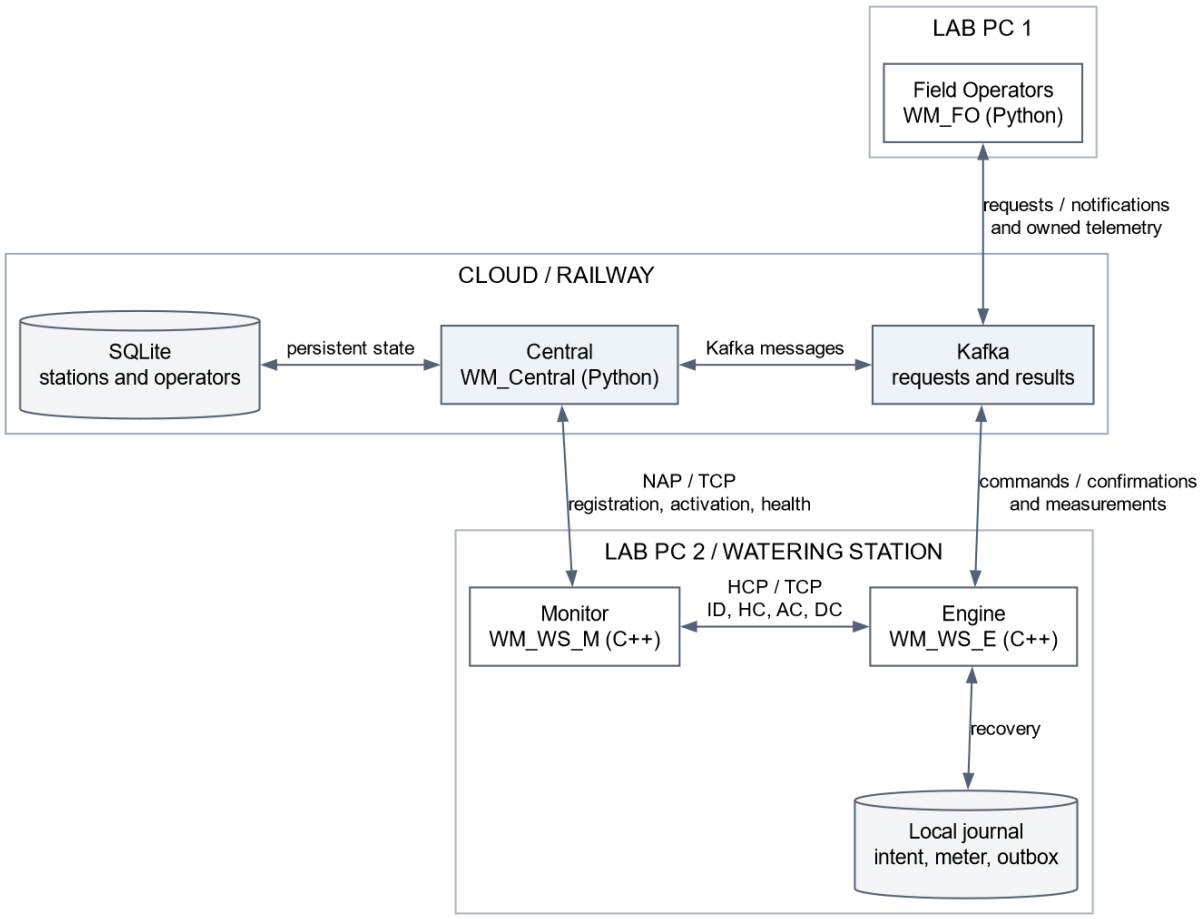


Figure 1: Components, communication paths and persistent state. The arrows show message exchange; TCP client/server roles are explained below.

We use two communication paths. **Kafka carries work and results**: requests, station commands, confirmations, measurements and final summaries. **TCP sockets carry supervision**: station registration, activation and health. This lets Central detect when a station loses its Monitor, even if Engine is still sending measurements.

Component	Main responsibility	What it talks to
Central	Register stations, coordinate operations and maintain the network view	Monitor over NAP; Kafka; SQLite
Field Operator	Let an operator request work and see their station's progress and result	Kafka
Engine	Control the valve, integrate measurements, execute commands and retain recovery data	Monitor over HCP; Kafka; local journal
Monitor	Check Engine and report station health independently	Engine over HCP; Central over NAP

Central, Kafka and SQLite are hosted in the cloud. The minimum lab scenario uses one machine for two FO instances and another for two watering stations. Each WS still consists of two independent processes and containers: Engine and Monitor. They share a Docker bridge network, not a process or network namespace.

On NAP, **Central is the TCP server and Monitor is the client**. On HCP, **Engine is the server and Monitor is the client**. This is the direction used in our implementation and the agreed clarification for the practice. Engine gets its station ID from Monitor's initial identification message, so both halves of a station use the same identity.

Python's `main()` functions start the service and workers. In C++, `WM_WS_E.cpp` and `WM_WS_M.cpp` parse options, open the log and call the application code. The protocol and watering logic are in separate files. See [S1], [S5], [S8] and [S9].

2. Following an irrigation request

Suppose operator **7** requests **120 seconds** of watering from station **1**. We use operation code **101** to keep this example readable.

1. FO publishes the request on `fo-req`.
2. Central checks that the station exists and is Available. A rejected request receives a reason; a valid one becomes an `IRRIGATION` command on `central-ops`.
3. Engine checks the command again because the station's state may have changed since Central accepted the request.
4. Before opening the valve, the station saves the intended operation. It then starts irrigation and queues an `OK` confirmation on `ws-start-conf`.
5. Central uses that confirmation to update the station and answer FO through `central-notis`. Operation code 101 identifies the request throughout.
6. While watering, Engine publishes telemetry once per second. Central can observe the station, and FO only displays telemetry addressed to its operator ID.
7. At the deadline, the valve closes. Engine queues `ws-finish-conf` with the final litres, duration and the operator who started the irrigation. Central forwards the summary to FO.

FO waits for Engine's confirmation before treating the irrigation as accepted. For example, a leak may appear after Central's check and prevent the valve from opening. When irrigation ends, the summary reports the water used and names the original operator, even if somebody else stopped it.

A manual start follows the same station-side rules. Its confirmation contains `station_id` and a null or omitted `operation_code`; Central recognises that the station initiated it. Its `operator_id` is null because no FO owns that session. See the handlers in [S1] and the station command path in [S10].

3. Central and the field operator

3.1 Central's coordination work

Central has two ways of receiving information: a TCP listener for Monitors and Kafka consumers for station/FO messages. A worker thread handles each accepted NAP connection. Separate Kafka workers dispatch incoming JSON to the handler for its topic. One slow station therefore does not occupy the whole server.

The request handler checks the requested action against the station's state. For example, an irrigation request needs an Available station; a BLOCK is refused during a leak. Central forwards the accepted command and saves its operation code so it can send the response to the right operator. It also refuses a request for another station while the same operator is already serving one.

The confirmation handler distinguishes station-initiated irrigation from a Central/FO operation. For a commanded operation, it uses the saved command type to interpret `OK`: `IRRIGATION` means Watering, `BLOCK` means Out of service, and `ACTIVATE` or `STOP` means Available. A `KO` includes the reason for rejection and leaves the state unchanged.

Central's network view uses the assignment's states: Available, Watering, Leak, Out of service and Disconnected. Health reports tell Central whether the station is responding and whether it has a fault. Operation confirmations tell it whether the station is watering or blocked. A health `OK` leaves an ongoing irrigation or block in place, including when messages from different topics arrive out of order. See [S1] and [S2].

Central's Flask dashboard opens in a browser and shows each station's ID, location and state. Watering rows also show the operator, flow in L/min and accumulated litres. Available uses green, Watering uses blinking green, Leak uses red, Out of service uses orange, and Disconnected uses grey. Central can send irrigation, BLOCK and ACTIVATE to one chosen station or all stations; STOP ends an individual irrigation without blocking it.

On startup, saved registrations are shown as Disconnected until their Monitors reconnect. Central estimates the volume shown during irrigation from the flow readings in `telemetry`. Engine sends the final measured total separately in `ws-finish-conf`.

3.2 SQLite and concurrent access

SQLite stores the stations' IDs, locations and states, together with registered operator IDs. The station table also keeps `previous_status` for leak recovery. We mount the database directory on persistent storage, so replacing a container does not remove its registration data.

Database writes go through a queue and a single writer thread. Read operations open their own connections, and WAL mode allows reads to proceed alongside the writer. This keeps the socket threads and Kafka workers from writing through the same SQLite connection concurrently.

Code that reads a newly added row has to wait for the writer to commit it. Saving a database change and acknowledging a Kafka message are also separate steps; a crash can occur between them. The database code is in [S3].

3.3 The operator's interface

FO lets the operator choose a station, request or stop irrigation, block or activate a station, and inspect the station list. We use a browser interface served by Flask. The page has action buttons, live flow and estimated volume, the last irrigation summary, and a log of confirmations, alerts and errors. It refreshes once per second. Each FO instance has its own operator ID and web port; it can run in a container while the browser runs on the host.

The browser sends actions to FO's local HTTP API. FO then sends JSON to Kafka and lets Central decide whether the request should proceed. It does not connect directly to a station. A background worker requests the station list through `GET-STATIONS` once per second. The HTTP requests stay between the browser and FO; communication with Central still uses Kafka.

Two consumer threads receive `central-notis` and `telemetry`. Command responses go into a queue and are matched by operation code. Telemetry updates shared state under a lock, which the web API reads for the page. FO estimates volume from the one-second flow readings; Engine supplies the final measured total. The summary also shows average flow. Restarting FO clears its displayed state, including the selected station, log and last summary.

Under **Batches**, the operator can choose a local text file with **Execute File** or paste its contents and use **Send Batch**. The browser reads the file and sends its contents to FO, so no container

volume mount is needed. Each non-empty line contains a station ID, optionally followed by `#` and a duration in seconds:

```
1#120
2
1#60
```

Here the second request has no duration limit. FO sends the same irrigation requests as the action buttons, in file order. It waits for each irrigation to end, then pauses four seconds before the next request. A rejected request is logged and skipped. For timed irrigation, a missing final summary triggers a timeout after the requested duration plus 15 seconds. An indefinite request needs to be stopped before playback can continue. The web interface and request handling are in [S5], the Kafka adapter and shared state in [S6], and file parsing in [S7].

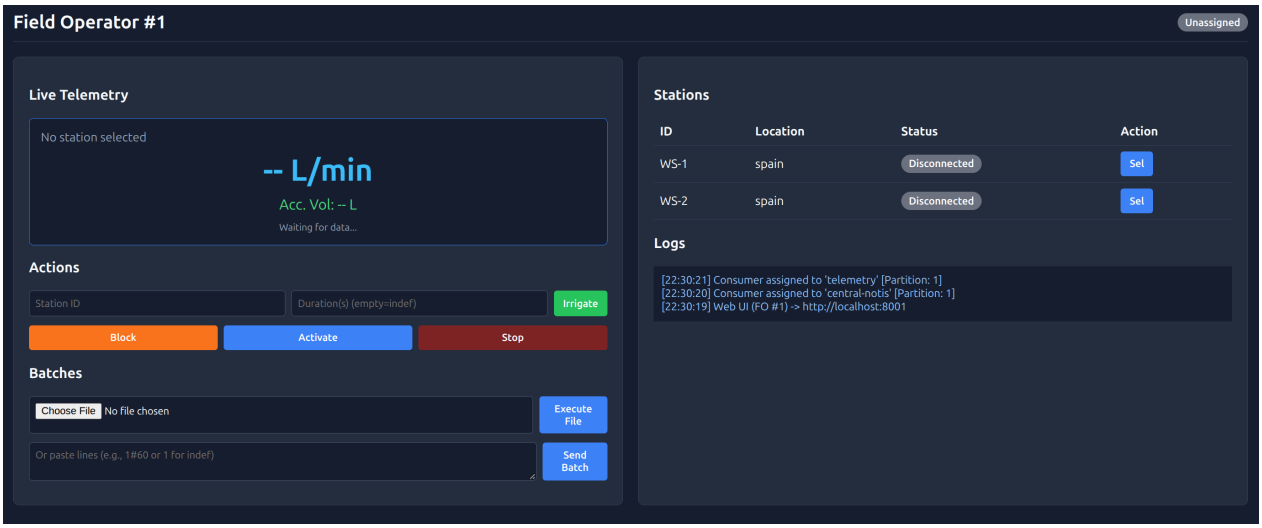


Figure 2: FO's browser interface, with irrigation controls, batch input, station states, live telemetry and the activity log.

4. Inside a watering station

4.1 Engine: the physical simulation and its permissions

Engine owns the simulated valve, flow meter and leak detector. A shared worker checks deadlines and sensors approximately every 100 ms. The `Engine` mutex protects its state, so command handling and fault handling cannot change the valve at the same time.

We simulate pressure variations of up to 2% below the configured flow. With a 40 L/min setting, readings stay between 39.2 and 40 L/min. To calculate the delivered volume, we integrate that varying flow over time. Closing the valve sets the final totals.

We use a steady clock for irrigation time and deadlines. Changing the machine's wall clock therefore does not change an irrigation's duration. Logs use UTC timestamps so we can compare events across processes.

Engine separates physical state from permissions. Idle, Watering and Fault are physical states; activation, Central availability, Monitor connectivity and administrative blocking are checked separately. A healthy station can still be blocked or waiting for authorisation. All these checks must pass before Engine opens the valve. See [S11] and [S12].

4.2 Start, STOP, BLOCK and ACTIVATE

Action	Meaning at the station
`IRRIGATION`	Start only if the station is active, healthy, supervised, unblocked and has Central available.
`STOP`	Close the current irrigation but keep activation. Also return `OK` if already Available.
`BLOCK`	End irrigation and deliberately disable new starts. Reject a new block during an active leak.
`ACTIVATE`	Clear a deliberate block when the health and supervision checks permit it. Do not start watering automatically.

We use STOP to end one irrigation while leaving the station ready for the next request. BLOCK puts it Out of service until it receives an external activation. STOP cannot repair a fault, unblock a station or authorise it.

A block accepted before a leak survives repair. A new block received during that leak is rejected with `KO`, without replacing the fault. We also preserve the saved block during restart, even if the sensor faults before recovery loads the journal. In that case, the block being restored was accepted before the fault.

The local Engine menu offers start, stop, fault, repair, status and quit. It refreshes watering time, flow and delivered volume without needing another command. Fault injection is also available while idle or blocked, so we can demonstrate the health behaviour without starting irrigation first.

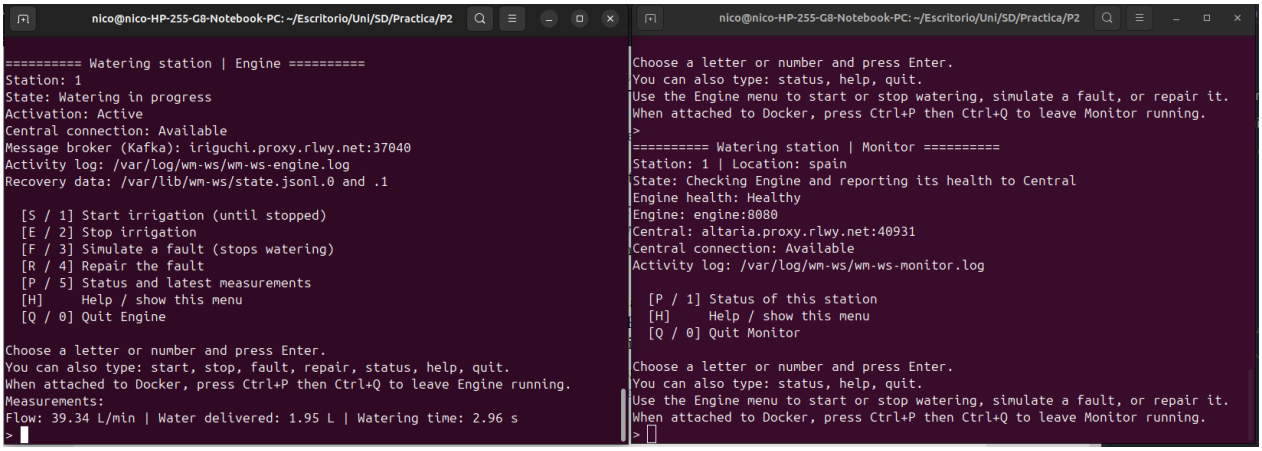


Figure 3: Station 1 watering at 39.34 L/min, with 1.95 L delivered. Its terminal Monitor reports a healthy Engine and an available Central connection.

4.3 Monitor: supervision without controlling the valve

Monitor checks Engine once per second over HCP. Its NAP Reporter runs separately, so a slow or unavailable Central does not stop local health checks. Before activating Engine over HCP, Monitor must receive Central's NAP activation and an acknowledgement of a healthy report. Sending the station ID alone does not authorise irrigation.

During a leak, HCP keeps responding `KO` and NAP keeps reporting `KO` on its persistent health connection. Repair changes reporting back to `OK`. Once that healthy report is acknowledged, Monitor renews Engine authorisation using HCP `AC`; it does not reopen the NAP activation connection just because a leak was repaired. This authorisation still cannot clear a Central block.

The terminal view and optional Qt panel use the same status observer. The panel shows the station, Engine health, last response time, Central connection and log path. Help, the read-only activity log and Quit have keyboard shortcuts; opening a dialog does not pause monitoring. Routine logs stay in files, while fatal errors remain visible with a suggested next step. See [S9], [S13] and [S14].

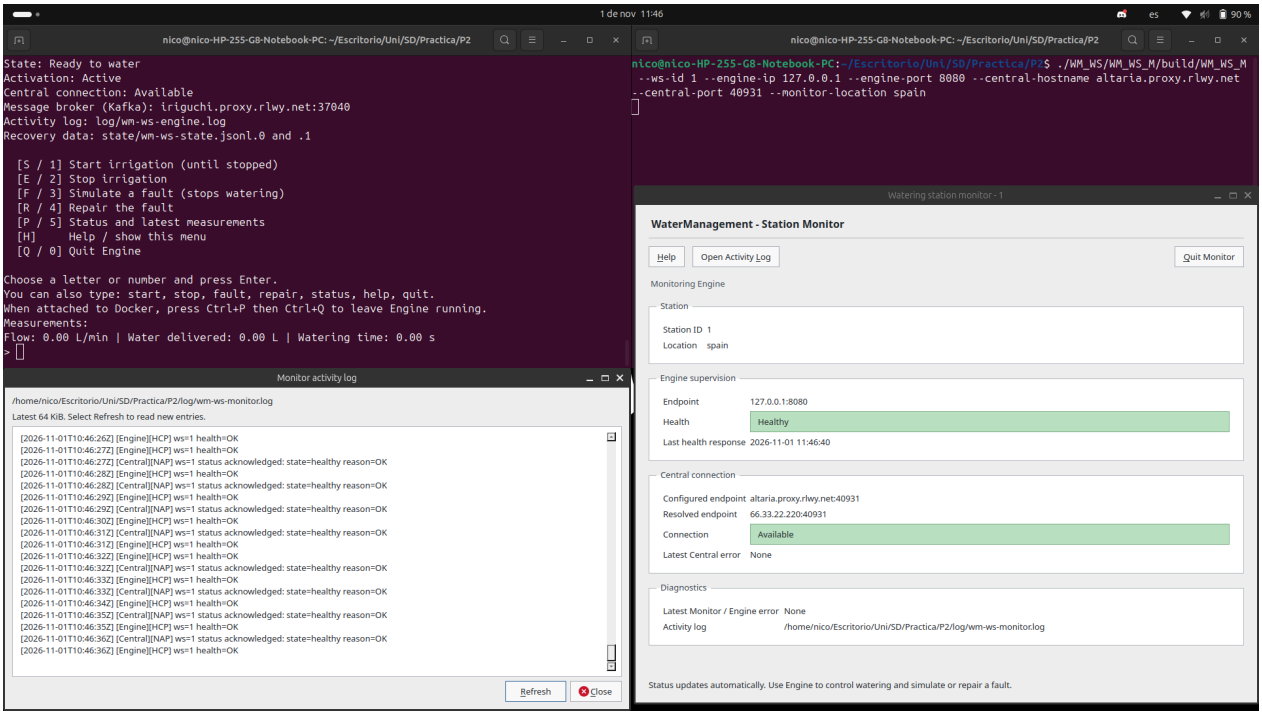


Figure 4: Qt Monitor for station 1, with Engine healthy, Central available and the activity log open. The log shows HCP checks and acknowledged NAP reports.

5. The socket protocols: NAP and HCP

5.1 NAP framing and validation

NAP is the Monitor–Central protocol. Messages are UTF-8 text with `#` separators:

`NAP#1.0#<ack-code>#<protocol-code>[#fields]#<LRC>#FIN`

`ack-code` identifies a request within its connection. The matching response must carry the same code and station ID. This is separate from a Kafka `operation_code`: one correlates a socket exchange; the other identifies a watering/control operation.

The LRC is the XOR of the bytes before the separator preceding the checksum. It is encoded as two uppercase hexadecimal digits. We exclude the checksum, its preceding `#`, and `#FIN` from the XOR. The checksum detects accidental changes to the frame, but provides no encryption or authentication.

Protocol code	Request/response body after the code
0 Registration	`<station-id>#<location>`
1 Activation	`<station-id>`
2 Health/status	`<station-id>#OK` or `<station-id>#KO`
3 ACK	`<station-id>`
4 NACK	`<error-code>#<station-id>`

For example, station 1's activation exchange is:

```
Monitor -> Central: NAP#1.0#1#1#1#41#FIN
Central -> Monitor: NAP#1.0#1#3#1#43#FIN
```

The NACK error codes are 0 for malformed syntax, 1 for an already registered station, 2 for an unknown station, and 3 for an unknown protocol code. An already-registered response lets Monitor proceed to activation while Central keeps the existing registration.

Registration and activation use separate short-lived connections. After them, health reporting uses one persistent connection. Both `OK` and `KO` receive an ACK, and a fault does not close that connection. The normal reporting interval is one second, configurable for tests.

TCP does not preserve application message boundaries. Central accumulates bytes until it finds `#FIN`; Monitor reads one complete response and validates the version, field count, request number, station ID and LRC. There is only one outstanding request per connection. A truncated or late frame cannot safely be reused as the reply to a different request. The wire specification and implementation are in [S2], [S13] and [S15].

5.2 HCP identification and two-byte messages

HCP needs fewer messages because it connects one Monitor to its Engine. Monitor connects to Engine and first sends:

```
ID 1\n
```

The newline terminates identification. Engine answers `OK` or `KO`. It stores the accepted ID and rejects a different identity on later connections until it restarts. HCP permits a wider text ID format for health-only use, but a complete Kafka deployment uses numeric station IDs.

After identification, each HCP request and response is exactly two bytes:

Request	Meaning	Response
`HC`	Check Engine health	`OK` or `KO`
`AC`	Apply acknowledged recovery/activation authorisation	`OK`, or `KO` if activation is refused
`DC`	Central is unavailable; prevent new starts	`OK` acknowledges receipt

No newline or null terminator follows these two-byte frames. The default operation deadline is two seconds. A partial read does not restart the deadline.

`HC` reports health and remembers a fault until it has been reported at least once, even if the leak was repaired between polls. `AC` requests activation, so its `KO` may mean that the hardware is healthy but Central deliberately blocked it. `DC` is an availability notification and must not consume a pending leak or close a valve that is allowed to finish its current irrigation.

When the HCP connection actually fails, Engine revokes activation, closes the valve and suppresses Kafka publication until supervision is restored. HCP and its deadline helpers are described in [S16] and implemented by [S17].

6. The Kafka messages

6.1 Topics, identities and routing

IDs are JSON numbers. `operation_code` is a nonnegative integer supporting FO's full 128-bit UUID range. It stays unchanged from FO's request through the command and confirmation. The

station preserves large codes as exact decimal digits and writes them as JSON numbers, avoiding a conversion through floating point [S23]. A command sent directly by Central has a null `operator_id`. A manually started irrigation has no external operation code.

Topic	Producer	Consumer(s)	Routing recipient
`fo-req`	FO	Central	Central consumes the topic
`central-ops`	Central	WS Engine	Station ID
`ws-start-conf`	WS Engine	Central	Central consumes all partitions
`ws-finish-conf`	WS Engine	Central	Central consumes all partitions
`telemetry`	WS Engine	Central and FO	Original operator ID; station ID for ownerless telemetry
`central-notis`	Central	FO	Operator ID

WS-produced records use `numeric_id % number_of_partitions` for the recipient. Central uses `operator_id % number_of_partitions` explicitly when producing `central-notis`. FO assigns its telemetry and notification consumers with this same modulo rule. Different IDs can share a partition, so the consumer must still filter the JSON recipient. For instance, operator IDs 1 and 4 share partition 1 when there are three partitions, but must not display each other's messages.

For `central-ops`, Central supplies the station ID as a Kafka key and uses librdkafka's default CRC32 partitioning. WS follows that key-based assignment, using the canonical decimal station ID, so it reads the partition where Central actually writes its commands. Recipient filtering still applies.

The README's sizing example assumes 1,500 operators over three partitions for operator messages and 2,000 stations over four command partitions. This gives roughly 500 IDs per partition; the running clients use the actual topic counts from Kafka.

WS queries Kafka metadata and refreshes its partition counts every five seconds. FO also queries its notification/telemetry topic counts when assigning its consumers. We use distinct station/operator consumer groups so adding an independent instance does not take over another recipient's commands. Changing a topic's partition count during irrigation would need extra handling because new messages can move to another partition while older ones remain in place. See [S4], [S6] and [S18].

6.2 Request, command and acknowledgement

The request from operator 7 is:

```
{
  "operator_id": 7,
  "station_id": 1,
  "command_type": "IRRIGATION",
  "operation_code": 101,
  "duration": 120
}
```

On `central-ops`, the corresponding object uses `type` instead of `command_type`; the other fields keep their meaning. `duration` is in seconds. Null or omitted duration means no automatic time limit. Central forwards the request only after checking the station, and Engine checks it again locally.

The other operational types are `BLOCK`, `ACTIVATE` and `STOP`; duration is ignored for them. FO also sends `GET-STATIONS` to refresh its station table; that request uses null `station_id` and `duration` fields. It is answered by Central without sending a station command. For example, this STOP ends the current irrigation without putting the station Out of service:

```
{
  "operator_id": 7,
  "station_id": 1,
  "type": "STOP",
  "operation_code": 102,
  "duration": null
}
```

The operation response on `ws-start-conf` is:

```
{
  "station_id": 1,
  "operation_code": 102,
  "status": "OK",
  "reason": null
}
```

Despite the topic's name, `ws-start-conf` confirms every operation, including STOP, BLOCK and ACTIVATE. A rejected operation uses `KO` and a readable reason. An already Available station acknowledges a new STOP with `OK` and creates no second final summary.

Engine remembers each normalised command and its result. Repeating the same operation code replays its confirmation; it does not repeat the valve action. Reusing that code with different content is rejected. For STOP, this prevents an old command from terminating a newer irrigation. See `Station::handle()` in [S10].

6.3 Measurements and completion

During watering, Engine sends three telemetry fields:

```
{"station_id": 1, "flux_l_min": 39.72, "operator_id": 7}
```

The flow is in litres per minute. Telemetry does not carry final accumulated usage; that belongs in `ws-finish-conf`. The agreed final-summary time unit is minutes, while request durations and Engine's internal elapsed time use seconds. Consumers convert between those units when displaying or processing the values.

```
{
  "station_id": 1,
  "status": "FINISHED",
  "total_liters": 79.4,
  "total_time": 2.0,
  "operator_id": 7
}
```

This example represents a two-minute session. The operator is the person who started the session. If another operator or Central stops it, the result still belongs to the original owner. Manual irrigation uses null ownership.

`FINISHED` records that a session ended, including sessions stopped by a leak or BLOCK. A late summary must leave the station's fault or block in place.

6.4 Notifications to FO

Central sends four notification types on `central-notis`:

Type	Meaning for FO
`RESPONSE`	Final OK/KO for a command, or the requested station list
`SUMMARY`	Final irrigation duration and litres used
`INFO`	Progress message while Central waits for the station
`ALERT`	A leak, disconnection, or an irrigation stopped or blocked by someone else

A command response keeps the original operation code:

```
{
  "operator_id": 7,
  "type": "RESPONSE",
  "operation_code": 101,
  "status": "OK",
  "reason": null
}
```

For `GET-STATIONS`, the response also carries a `stations` array of `[station_id, location, status]` entries. After irrigation, a `SUMMARY` notification carries `summary: [station_id, total_time_minutes, total_litres]`. These tuples become JSON arrays; they are not Python-specific objects on the wire. Central rounds the summary's duration and litres to two decimal places.

An `INFO` includes a `message` describing progress. For example, Central can report that it has forwarded the irrigation request:

```
{
  "operator_id": 7,
  "type": "INFO",
  "operation_code": 101,
  "message": "Irrigation request sent to WS-1; waiting for response"
}
```

This does not confirm that watering has started. FO still waits for the `RESPONSE` produced after the station's acknowledgement.

An `ALERT` has a `reason` code and a readable `message`. The reason can be `DISCONNECTED`, `LEAK`, `BLOCK` or `STOP`. The last two notify the operator serving the station when Central or a different FO interrupts the irrigation:

```
{
  "operator_id": 7,
  "type": "ALERT",
  "status": "KO",
  "reason": "BLOCK",
  "message": "Station WS-1 was blocked by another operator"
}
```

FO writes `INFO` and `ALERT` messages to its activity log. They do not replace the command response or final summary. Fields that are irrelevant to a notification may be omitted or null.

FO filters messages by operator ID before displaying them because several operators can share a partition. The topic definitions are in [S19], with the message adapters in [S4] and [S6].

7. State, concurrency and recovery

7.1 Component failures

Event	Local effect	Recovery rule
Leak	Close the valve immediately; keep reporting `KO`	Repair, acknowledged healthy reporting and HCP authorisation; no automatic watering resume
Monitor stops	Engine stops watering and withholds Kafka publication	Restore supervision and authorisation
Engine stops	Monitor reports failure; Central shows the fault	Restore saved usage and send the interrupted session's final result
Central stops	Existing irrigation can finish; new starts are refused	Reconnect/re-authorise without restarting healthy components
FO stops	The station continues its service	Restart with the same operator ID and refresh the station list; the displayed session is not saved
Kafka is unavailable	Retain pending station events locally	Retry delivery after the broker returns

If Engine stops but Monitor is still running, Monitor reports the failure to Central. If Monitor stops, Central receives no health messages and shows Disconnected, even if Engine is still running and sending telemetry.

When Central fails, Monitor can still supervise the valve locally, so an existing irrigation may finish. Monitor sends `DC` to prevent another start. When Central returns and acknowledges the reports, Monitor can authorise Engine again. Repair or reconnecting never clears an administrative block by itself.

7.2 The station journal and pending messages

We split Engine's Kafka code into three parts. `Station` handles commands and watering sessions, `Service` manages the broker clients and worker, and `Journal` saves the local state. This lets us test command handling without running a broker.

The journal uses two alternating files, suffixed `.0` and `.1`. Each stores a JSON object containing a revision and a state snapshot. On load, we parse both and choose the highest valid revision. If a crash interrupts the latest write, the older valid snapshot can still be loaded. If neither file is valid, Engine reports a storage error and refuses to start with empty state.

The snapshot contains the station identity, administrative block, current session, pending intent, command/result cache, meter totals and outgoing events. An outgoing event stores its topic, recipient and JSON value. The journal uses its own format for recovery. Schema version 2 keeps meter time in seconds and outgoing final durations in minutes. Older checkpoints remain readable; pending final durations from the previous schema are converted once when loaded. Large operation codes use decimal strings inside this local file, while their Kafka representation remains numeric.

We save the intended operation before changing the valve, and save outgoing records before sending them to Kafka. A record is removed only after its broker delivery callback succeeds and that removal is saved. The producer's idempotence helps broker retries, but the application guarantee remains **at least once**: a crash after broker acceptance and before the local removal checkpoint can replay a record. Central must handle duplicate records when this happens.

The file write is flushed and synchronised before the revision advances. Windows uses the native commit operation; Unix uses file and directory `fsync`. We select these implementations using ninttp's platform flags. See [S10], [S18] and [S20].

7.3 Retaining measurements without reopening the valve

The simulated meter makes a progress snapshot available only after saving it. We sample about every 100 ms; the actual interval depends on thread scheduling and disk writes. The disk write happens outside Engine's state mutex, so closing a valve does not have to wait for storage.

After a crash, the station restores the saved totals and owner, ends the interrupted session and keeps its final result for delivery. It does not reopen irrigation or count the time spent offline. A generation check prevents a delayed snapshot from an older irrigation overwriting a new one.

Recovery is limited to the last saved measurements. Each independent station needs its own persistent volume so its journal survives container replacement and does not get overwritten by another station.

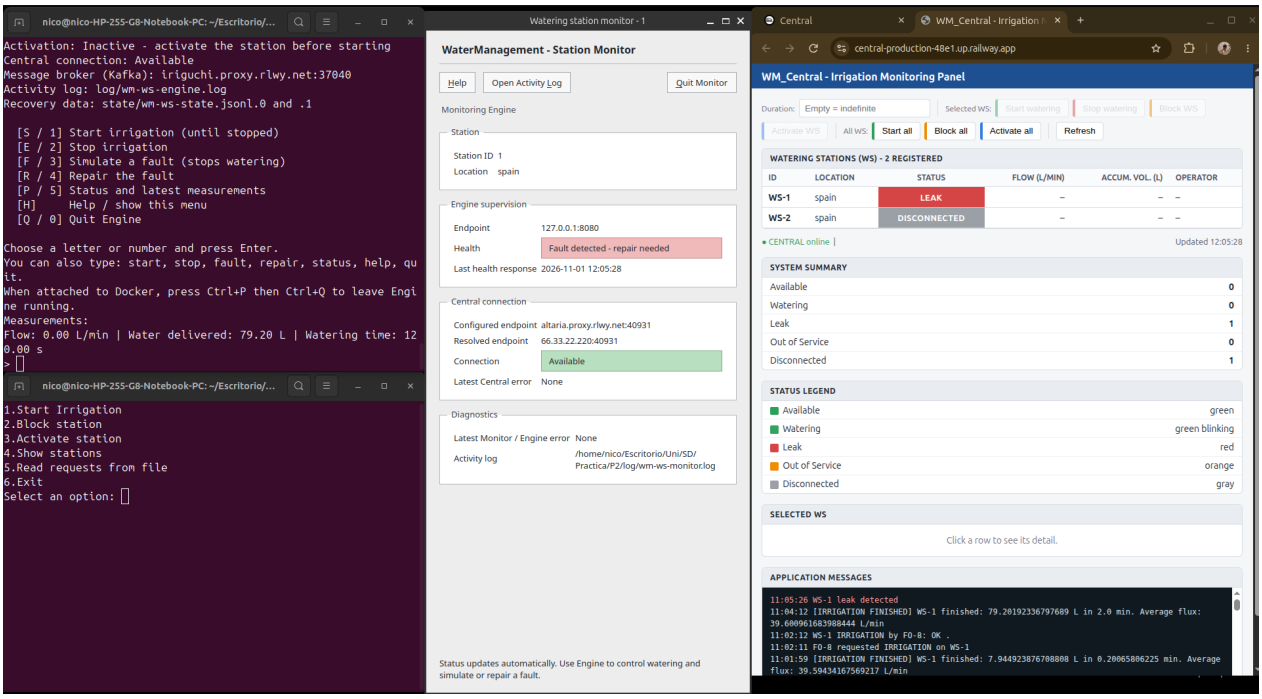


Figure 5: Leak at station 1: Engine's flow is zero, Monitor reports a fault, and Central shows LEAK. Monitor remains connected to Central; station 2 is Disconnected.

8. Deployment

8.1 Preparing the cloud and images

We prepare the cloud before the lab demonstration. Kafka must advertise an address reachable by the clients, Central must listen on its configured TCP port, and SQLite must use a mounted persistent directory. We pass the Central and Kafka addresses as configuration when starting WS.

The six required Kafka topics are `telemetry`, `fo-req`, `central-notis`, `ws-finish-conf`, `central-ops` and `ws-start-conf`. We create them before launching clients and use the same partition counts at both ends of each recipient-routed interface.

Build the images **before** grading, from the repository root:

```
docker build -t wm-central WM_Central
docker build -t wm-fo WM_FO
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-1 build
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-2 build
```

The WS build context is `WM_WS`, not an individual executable folder, because both modules need shared headers and CMake support. Compose reads that context from its file and prepares image tags for each project. Building both `ws-1` and `ws-2` beforehand avoids building missing images during grading. Python images use Python 3.12 and install Flask and `confluent-kafka`; SQLite comes with Python. The C++ builds use CMake, Boost and ninttp, plus librdkafka for Engine. Qt is optional for Monitor; the container commands below use its terminal frontend. See [S21] and [S22].

For a self-managed Central container, its equivalent cloud configuration is:

```
docker volume create wm-central-db
docker run -d --name wm-central -p 8080:8080 -p 8000:8000 \
  -v wm-central-db:/data -e DB_DIR=/data wm-central \
  --server-ip 0.0.0.0 --port 8080 \
  --kafka-ip iriguchi.proxy.rlwy.net --kafka-port 37040
```

On Railway, the same image/service receives these settings and a persistent mount through the service configuration. Its public TCP proxy forwards to the internal listening port. Central and SQLite are one application deployment with a mounted database; SQLite is not a separate TCP database server. The local command also publishes Central's browser dashboard at `http://localhost:8000`. Its web port is set by `WEB_PORT`, independently of NAP.

8.2 Starting two field operators on lab PC 1

Use a separate terminal for each operator. These commands use the `wm-fo` image built in section 8.1:

```
docker run --rm -p 8001:8001 wm-fo 1 --web-port 8001 \
  --kafka-ip iriguchi.proxy.rlwy.net --kafka-port 37040

docker run --rm -p 8002:8002 wm-fo 2 --web-port 8002 \
  --kafka-ip iriguchi.proxy.rlwy.net --kafka-port 37040
```

Open `http://localhost:8001` for operator 1 and `http://localhost:8002` for operator 2. The terminals show service logs; the controls are in the browser. The default web port is `8000 + operator_id`, and the published container port must match `--web-port`. To run a request file, choose it under **Batches** and click **Execute File**. The file is read by the browser on the host.

8.3 Starting two watering stations on lab PC 2

We use Compose to supply the images, networks, persistent volumes and environment settings, but launch each application with `run` in its own terminal. Each pair uses its own project name. The commands below use the images built in section 8.1, so there is no `--build` during the demonstration.

Terminal 1 - station 1, Engine:

```
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-1 run \
  --no-deps --use-aliases --name wm-engine-1 engine
```

Terminal 2 - station 1, Monitor:

```
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-1 run \
  --no-deps --name wm-monitor-1 -e WS_ID=1 monitor
```

Terminal 3 - station 2, Engine:

```
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-2 run \
  --no-deps --use-aliases --name wm-engine-2 engine
```

Terminal 4 - station 2, Monitor:

```
docker compose -f WM_WS/compose.yaml -p ws-2 run \
  --no-deps --name wm-monitor-2 -e WS_ID=2 monitor
```

`--no-deps` launches only the selected application. `--use-aliases` makes Engine reachable as `engine` on that project's network, which is the hostname supplied to Monitor by the Compose file. Both terminals for one station must use the same project name. The container names and station IDs are different between pairs; project-specific state and log volumes are created automatically.

The default endpoints are:

- Kafka: `iriguchi.proxy.rlwy.net:37040`.
- Central NAP: `altaria.proxy.rlwy.net:40931`.

The file accepts `QUEUE_ENDPOINT`, `CENTRAL_HOSTNAME` and `CENTRAL_PORT` overrides from the shell or a Compose `--env-file`. Monitor resolves Engine's name on every connection attempt, so recreating Engine does not require restarting Monitor just to refresh an IP address.

These are independent interactive containers. They do not need `compose up` or a shared network namespace. After a container exits, use `docker start -ai wm-engine-1` or `docker start -ai wm-monitor-1` in its own terminal; station 2 uses the corresponding `-2` names. To change configuration, remove and recreate the stopped container while retaining the project's volumes. A new station uses another project, unique container names and a new `WS_ID`.

The commands use Bash line continuations. In PowerShell, paste each command on one line. Run them from the repository root in every terminal. The build guide lists native builds, container commands and executable options [S21].

8.4 Native builds and complete executable commands

Getting the C++ modules to run on Windows and Linux took more than changing compilers. C++23 has no standard socket API, and Windows and Unix differ in socket types, error handling and available functions [S25]. We used ninttp for NAP and HCP, so both modules share the same socket and DNS code on either system [S24]. Its platform flags also select our console, logging and journal implementations. With CMake and the matching dependencies, we built and tested Engine and Monitor on both systems, including Monitor's Qt interface. Getting the same C++ sources working in both environments is one of the results we are most pleased with.

For native builds, use CMake 3.21 or newer, a C++23 compiler and dependencies built for that toolchain. On Windows we use MSYS2 MinGW64 and put its `bin` directory on PATH. Configure and build the modules with:

```
cmake -S WM_WS/WM_WS_E -B WM_WS/WM_WS_E/build \
  -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release \
  -DBUILD_TESTING=ON -DBUILD_EXAMPLES=OFF
cmake --build WM_WS/WM_WS_E/build \
  --config Release --parallel 2
```

```
cmake -S WM_WS/WM_WS_M -B WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build \
  -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release \
  -DBUILD_TESTING=ON -DBUILD_GUI=OFF
cmake --build WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build \
  --config Release --parallel 2
```

`BUILD_TESTING=OFF` omits tests and GoogleTest. Engine's `BUILD_EXAMPLES=ON` adds the example targets; Monitor's `BUILD_GUI=ON` selects Qt instead of the terminal frontend. Release chooses the build configuration, and `--parallel 2` limits concurrent build jobs. With a multi-configuration generator, the executable can be under `Release/`; on Windows its filename ends in `.exe`.

Run Engine in one terminal:

```
./WM_WS/WM_WS_E/build/WM_WS_E \
  --queue iriguchi.proxy.rlwy.net:37040 \
  --hcp-port 8080 \
  --hcp-timeout-ms 2000 \
  --state-file state/wm-ws-state.jsonl \
  --log-file log/wm-ws-engine.log
```

Run Monitor in another terminal:

```
./WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build/WM_WS_M \
  --ws-id 1 \
  --engine-ip 127.0.0.1 --engine-port 8080 \
  --hcp-timeout-ms 2000 --hcp-retry-ms 1000 \
  --nap-interval-ms 1000 --nap-timeout-ms 2000 \
  --central-hostname altaria.proxy.rlwy.net \
  --central-port 40931 \
  --monitor-location spain \
  --log-file log/wm-ws-monitor.log
```

For DNS-based discovery, use `--engine-hostname localhost` instead of the IP option, substituting Engine's reachable hostname. These alternatives are mutually exclusive. `--ws-id` is required for Monitor; Engine obtains that ID over HCP. Both HCP ports must agree. Positive timeouts, retries and intervals are in milliseconds; the station location must be nonempty and contain no `#`. Use distinct state/log paths and HCP ports for independent native station pairs.

The `--help` option prints the available parameters without starting network services:

```
./WM_WS/WM_WS_E/build/WM_WS_E --help
./WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build/WM_WS_M --help
```

For Monitor's Qt build, keep a separate build directory:

```
cmake -S WM_WS/WM_WS_M -B WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build/gui \
  -DCMAKE_BUILD_TYPE=Release \
  -DBUILD_TESTING=ON -DBUILD_GUI=ON
cmake --build WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build/gui \
  --config Release --parallel 2
```

Launch `WM_WS/WM_WS_M/build/gui/WM_WS_M` with the same complete Monitor arguments shown above, adding `.exe` or the configuration directory when needed. Qt builds require a graphical display and the Qt libraries/plugins alongside the program. For the lab assessment, we use the prebuilt container images.

8.5 What we demonstrate

We first show both stations registered and healthy, then request timed and manual irrigation. We demonstrate STOP, BLOCK/ACTIVATE, a rejected request, and a leak followed by repair. Finally we stop Monitor, Engine, FO and Central in separate scenarios, restoring only the components that actually need it.

We leave the endpoints, station/operator IDs and current state visible so the observer can follow the same request across screens. To simulate an abrupt failure, we use `docker kill`. Detaching with `Ctrl+P`, then `Ctrl+Q` leaves the container running. The grading run uses prepared images and requires no recompilation.

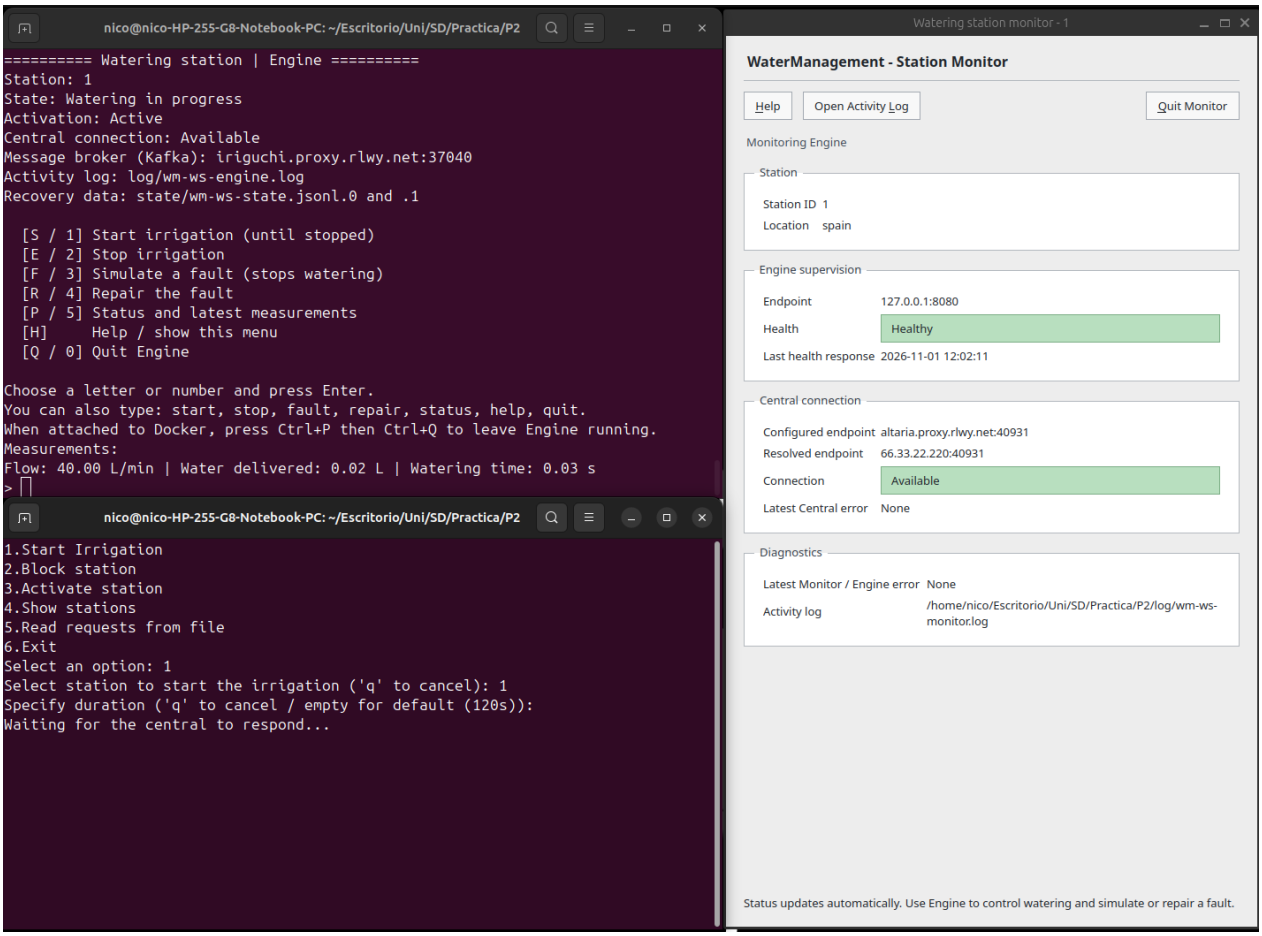


Figure 6: FO requests a 120-second irrigation from station 1. Engine shows watering in progress, while the Qt Monitor reports a healthy Engine and an available Central connection.

9. Testing and results

We tested the station in layers. Engine tests exercise the valve, deadlines, flow integration and state guards. Station tests feed JSON directly into the command path. Service tests use a mock Kafka broker for routing, delivery failures and retained records. Process tests launch real Engine/Monitor executables against local peers, including abrupt termination and recovery.

We recorded these results:

Check	Result	Behaviour tested
Engine/Station/Journal/Service suite, Windows	76 passed	Core behaviour, UUID correlation, routing, minute-based totals and local recovery
Same Engine suite, Linux containers	76 passed	The same checks with the container's Boost and Kafka libraries
Monitor backend and GUI suite, Windows/Linux	39 passed on each	NAP validation, continuous fault reporting, GUI controls and shutdown
Native process integration	22 passed	Real executable supervision, socket failures and crash recovery
Independent Docker/Compose smoke checks	13 passed	Startup order, DNS reconnection, volumes and pair isolation

Engine and native process checks were rerun on 30 October 2026. The Monitor and Docker smoke results are from 28–29 October. The 39 Monitor tests include the backend tests as well as the GUI tests. We ran these checks locally, using test peers and a mock broker for failure scenarios.

During the demonstration, we also check the states shown by Central and FO, the operation codes in the confirmations and the final usage:

Scenario	Expected result
Successful/rejected request	Same operation code at FO, Central and station; clear OK/KO
STOP	Valve closed, final summary retained, station still Available
Leak then repair	Immediate stop, repeated KO, later OK; no watering resume
Block before leak	Repair does not clear the earlier block
Monitor crash	Central shows Disconnected; Engine stops and cannot start manually
Engine crash	Monitor reports failure; restart retains committed usage and final result
FO crash	Irrigation continues; FO restarts with the same ID and refreshes the station list
Central crash	Current irrigation finishes; new starts wait for Central

The screenshots show irrigation, healthy monitoring and a leak with the cloud Central connected. We keep the logs and deployment commands alongside these captures to explain the run during the practical defence.

9.1 Timed irrigation from FO

We select station 1 in FO's browser page, enter five seconds and click **Irrigate**. The log shows the request, confirmation and completion. Once the time runs out, the station is Available again and **Last Summary** shows the duration, litres used and average flow.

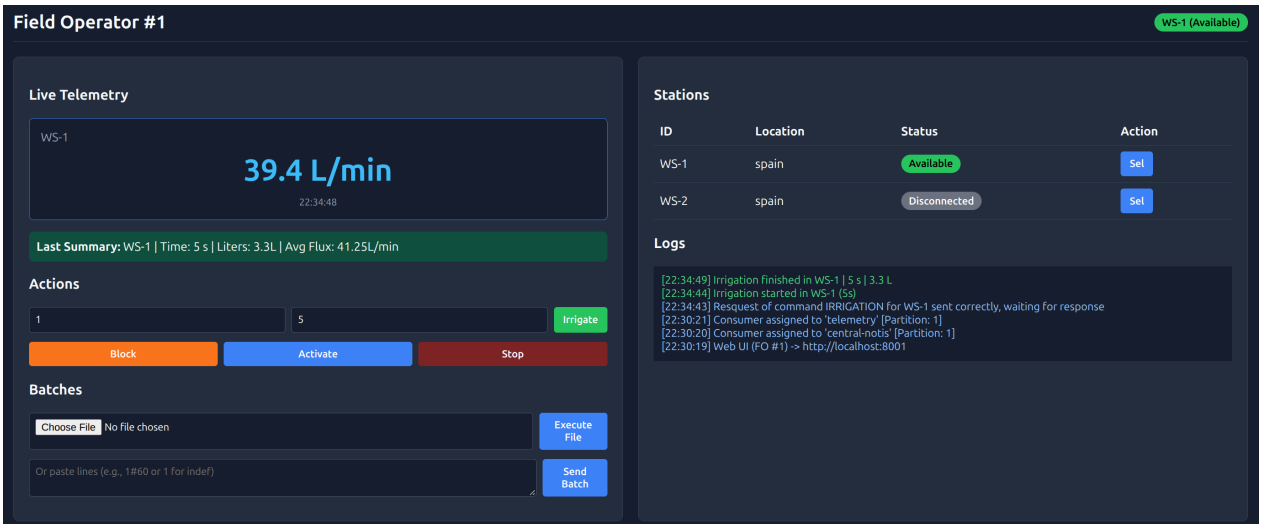


Figure 7: FO after a five-second irrigation at station 1. The final summary reports 3.3 L, and the log records the start and finish.

9.2 Blocking a station from FO

We select an Available station, click **Block** and check the confirmation in FO's log. The station table should show Out of service, and a new irrigation request should be rejected. We then click **Activate** to make it available again.

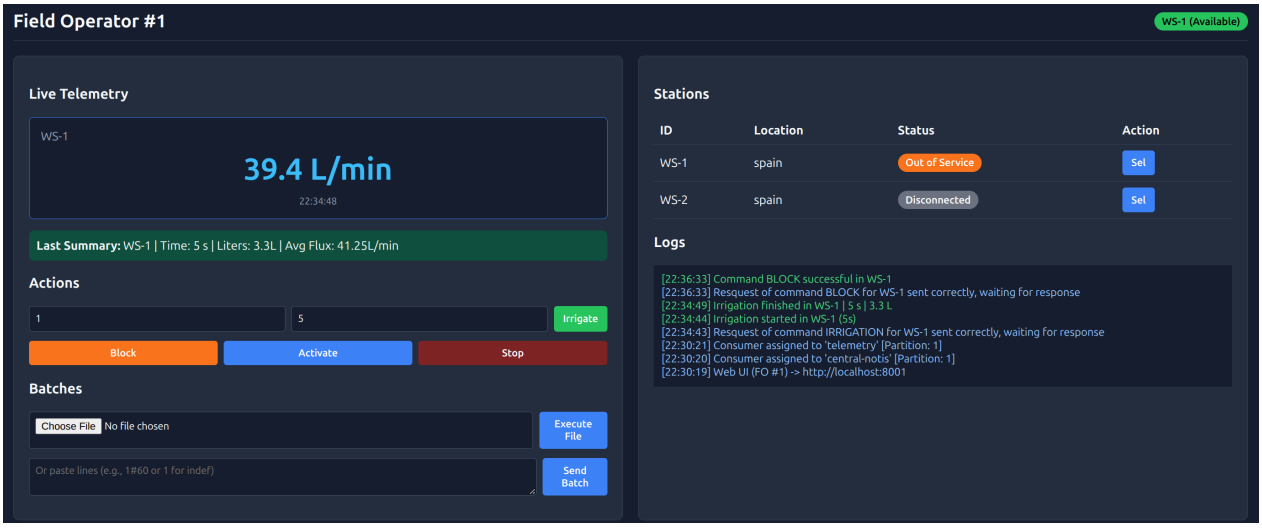


Figure 8: FO's station table and log after a block request.

9.3 Reading requests from a file

Under **Batches**, we choose a text file with one `station_id#seconds` request per line and click **Execute File**. We check that FO sends the requests in order, waits for each irrigation to finish and pauses four seconds before the next one. The batch entries in the log let us compare the run with the file.

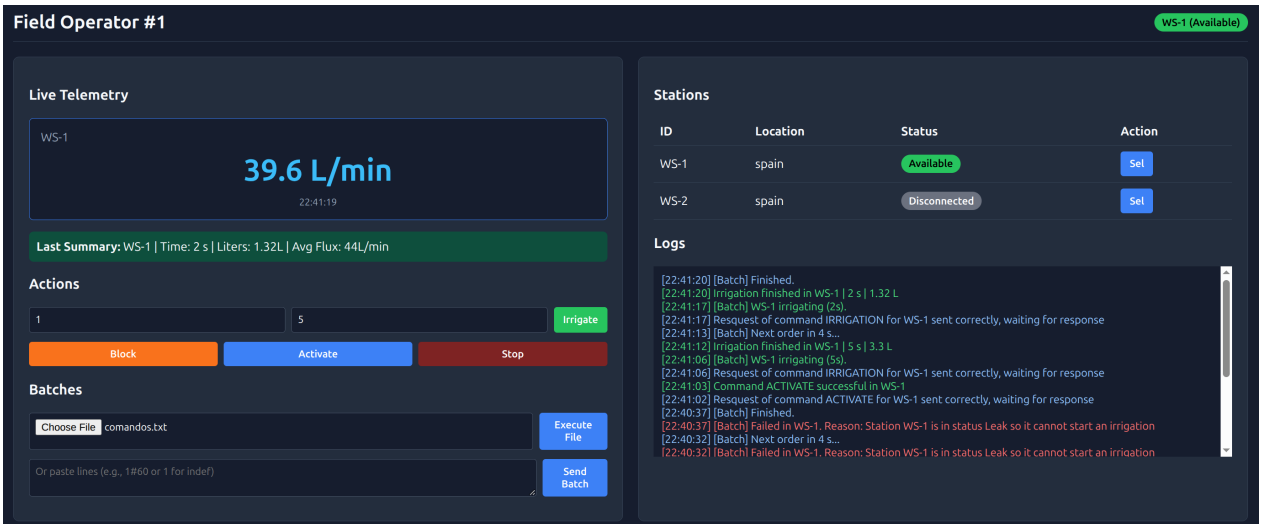


Figure 9: FO's file input and batch log, including completed requests and rejected irrigation attempts.

10. Source references

The project links below refer to repository snapshot `03aec17`. Each entry names the files and functions discussed in the report. The ninttp link uses the revision selected by our CMake configuration.

Ref.	Source and reading focus
[S1]	WM_Central.py and Central web API: NAP workers, Kafka handlers and browser controls.
[S2]	Central NAPManager.py: framing, LRC, registration, activation and persistent health handling.
[S3]	DBManager.py: schema, WAL, write queue and reads.
[S4]	Central kafka_clients.py: producer, consumer workers and JSON dispatch.
[S5]	WM_FO.py, FO web API and browser page: startup, command responses, station polling and batch playback.
[S6]	FO kafka_clients.py and shared_status.py: partition assignment, recipient filtering, display state and summaries.
[S7]	FO utils.py: request-file parsing and duration formatting.
[S8]	Engine app.cpp: Engine, Kafka, console and health-server lifetime.
[S9]	Monitor app.cpp: HCP session, health polling and recovery authorisation.
[S10]	Station implementation: command validation, deduplication, sessions, summaries and checkpoint recovery.
[S11]	Engine implementation: guarded state transitions, fault handling, deadlines and meter snapshots.

Ref.	Source and reading focus
[S12]	Flow meter: pressure variation and integrated litres.
[S13]	Reporter and Connection: asynchronous reporting and validated NAP exchanges.
[S14]	Qt window and GUI guide: status, activity log and graceful close.
[S15]	NAP specification: shared frame and error-code definitions.
[S16]	HCP specification: ID, HC, AC, DC and deadlines.
[S17]	Health server and HCP helpers: exact frames and failed-session cleanup.
[S18]	Kafka Service: worker, metadata routing, durable send and broker callbacks.
[S19]	Repository README: Kafka topics, notification fields and partition sizing.
[S20]	Journal: alternating snapshots, validation and file synchronisation.
[S21]	WS build commands, Compose and FO setup: native builds and container deployment.
[S22]	Central Dockerfile, FO Dockerfile, Engine Dockerfile and Monitor Dockerfile: image build and startup.
[S23]	Kafka codec: lossless UUID parsing, operation keys and numeric wire serialization.
[S24]	ninttp: the socket and DNS library used by Engine and Monitor, including its platform flags.
[S25]	GCC library headers and Microsoft's Winsock porting guide: networking extensions outside the C++23 standard library and differences between Windows and Unix sockets.